

MEETING OF THE MINDS (MOM) DOCUMENT

Service Cloud Order and Inventory Planning

MEETING DETAILS

Attribute	Details
Meeting Title	Service Cloud Order and Inventory Planning
Date	September 29, 2026
Time	2:14 PM UTC
Duration	121 minutes
Host	srinivas@miqdigital.com
Attendees	Swoop - Conference Room
Meeting ID	01M3PR86Z3VP50NE9BTR1DM4W6

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This strategic planning session focused on designing Salesforce Service Cloud and Ascent integration for order and inventory management. The team addressed rental operations, sales processes, purchase order (PO) workflows, vendor management, and financial integrations with Acumatica. Key discussions centered on system architecture decisions, data migration strategy, and operational process flows.

KEY DISCUSSION TOPICS

1. Item Master Requirements [00:00 - 02:05]

- **Five Required Fields Identified:** Only 5 mandatory fields needed for item creation
- **Recommended Fields:** Cost, price, minimum quantities for operational flexibility
- **Impact:** Rental and sales processes can operate with minimal required data
- **Decision Point:** Operational flexibility prioritized for field teams

2. Inbound Interaction Request Tracking [00:02 - 04:56]

- **Current State:** Spreadsheet-based tracking of requests from portals, emails, and calls
- **Scope:** Excludes ADI/order sources (handled separately)
- **Hub Approach:** Service Cloud as central repository for all interactions
- **Case Management:** Every interaction will have a case to capture critical information
- **Classification:** Cases will be typed as rental, pickup, swap, sales, or service requests

3. Rental Order Flow [06:00 - 07:00]

- **Process:** Case → Rental Order → Work Order (for delivery)
- **Sales Order Flow:** Case → Sales Order → Work Order (for delivery)
- **Service/Swap:** Case → Work Order (direct)
- **Consistent Outcome:** All interactions result in a work order for operations

4. Legacy Sales Orders and Pickup Handling [00:06 - 00:09]

- **Open Question:** How to handle pickups of items from field before system launch
- **Challenge:** Equipment may still be in field without new system work order references
- **Options Discussed:**
 - Reference legacy work order number

- Create Ascent sales order retroactively
- Implement blind return functionality
- **Decision Required:** Operational policy needed before go-live

5. Returns Without Pre-existing Sales Orders [00:08 - 00:12]

- **Requirement:** Need blind return functionality or background order staging
- **Rationale:** Field equipment can be returned without pre-existing order
- **Approach:** Manual fallback processes necessary; expect 98% coverage with exceptions
- **Business Question:** How to handle edge cases when orders cannot be found

6. System Cutover and Data Migration [00:12 - 00:15]

- **Preference:** Clean cutover (not parallel systems)
- **Data Migration Strategy:** Separate documentation required
- **Scope Decision:** All open transactions to be migrated
- **Timeline:** Cutover period should be minimized
- **Consideration:** Equipment in field may take months to return; strategy must account for this

7. Case Management Strategy [00:15 - 00:17]

- **Case Lifecycle:** Remain open until sales or rental orders finalized
- **Data Mapping:** All current data points from legacy systems to be enumerated
- **Reservations:** Items/item families linked to cases
- **Rental Locations:** Warehouses and trucks both function as rental locations

8. Rental Asset Swaps [00:17 - 00:20]

- **Process:** Swap treated as continuation of rental (no billing interruption)
- **Equity Continuation:** Rental equity continues through swap; supports buyout potential
- **Tracking:** Serial number changes tracked with history
- **Documentation:** Order maintains separate PAC line; serial number tracker updated
- **Integration:** GT (financial system) notified of serial number changes

9. Preventive Maintenance Scheduling [00:18 - 00:19]

- **Mechanism:** Serial number tracker provides maintenance scheduling capability
- **Fields:** Start and end date fields available out-of-box
- **Flexibility:** Can extend with additional periods if needed
- **Action:** Review maintenance schedule and map to available fields

10. Service Cloud vs. Sales Cloud Orientation [00:20 - 00:23]

- **Approach:** Service Cloud-centric (unusual but justified)
- **Rationale:** Large installed base requires single customer front-door
- **Industry Context:** Typically Sales Cloud-centric; this is a variation
- **Configuration Need:** Platform configuration required to manage parent-child relationships
- **Licensing Consideration:** Service Cloud for remaining 500 users; platform licenses available

11. Hub Object Decision [00:23 - 00:26]

- **Options Discussed:**
 - Service Cloud Case (traditional but licensing implications)

- Custom object (configuration-based)
- Sales Order as intake hub (aligns with Ascent design)
- **Advantages of Sales Order Approach:**
 - Portals already support sales order access
 - Closest to typical Ascent design patterns
 - Portal users can self-serve create orders
 - All API tools designed to create sales orders
- **Decision Timeline:** Required soon (driving factor for project planning)
- **Alternative:** Quote objects available for pre-order phase

12. Omnichannel Intake [00:24 - 00:27]

- **Channels:** Multiple intake points (portals, calls, EDI, emails)
- **Deduplication:** Needed to prevent duplicate orders
- **Object Selection:** Decision pending on hub object drives intake design

13. Patient Data at Order Level [00:29 - 00:32]

- **Current:** Patient data at header level
- **Invoicing Requirement:** Need patient data at line level
- **Not Either/Or:** Data can exist at both header and line levels
- **Billing Information:** Delivery and billing info must be at header level
- **Single Invoice Model:** Typically one order = one invoice (one order ≠ multiple invoices)
- **Action:** Finalize invoicing requirements to determine data mapping

14. Out-of-the-Box Ascent Capabilities [00:32 - 00:35]

- **Coverage:** Expected to cover most rental and sales needs
- **Configuration vs. Customization:** Small configurations anticipated
- **Item Categorization Risk:** Complexity may emerge from item master categorization
- **Order Entry Filtering:** May require deeper filtering than standard configuration

15. Item Mapping and Rental Billing [00:35 - 00:38]

- **Billing Basis:** Rental billing based on on-site duration, not packed sales lines
- **Rental Location Tracking:** Customers' locations managed as inventory locations
- **Invoice Generation:** Based on what customer has on-site and duration held
- **Differentiation:** Sales (based on packed line) vs. Rental (based on on-site duration)

16. Patient Information Access Controls [00:38 - 00:39]

- **Alignment Requirement:** Must align with Salesforce platform controls
- **Ownership:** Salesforce team and partner to lead this workstream
- **Native Objects:** Ascent objects use same access control as Salesforce
- **Scope:** Separate but parallel to core implementation

PURCHASE ORDER (PO) PROCESS DISCUSSION

17. Customer vs. Vendor POs [00:42 - 00:47]

- **Customer POs:** Related to sales orders (1,800 customers require POs)
- **Vendor POs:** Related to procurement and asset lifecycle
- **Timing Flexibility:** PO capture at call vs. at invoicing (flexibility needed)

- **PO Levels:** Can apply at customer, facility, or modality level
- **Split POs:** Not within single order; one order = one PO number
- **Blank POs:** Vendor POs can cover multiple orders with auto-application

18. PO Initiation Points [00:47 - 00:52]

- **Sources Identified:**
 1. Biomed technician parts requests
 2. ServiceNow tickets for work orders
 3. Work orders lacking parts inventory
 4. Manual requisition requests
 5. Vendor portals
- **Future Goal:** Streamline PO process for all inventory-related items
- **Priority:** Focus on inventory-impacting assets
- **Scope:** Vendor PO may cover multiple uses beyond rental/sales

19. PO Requisition Structure [00:52 - 00:55]

- **Statuses:** Draft → Approved → Active
- **Draft PO Risk:** Need controls to prevent incorrect drafts from field users
- **Approval Chains:** Salesforce-native approval process
- **Role Separation:** Separate approver roles and request initiators
- **PO Types:** Standard types with differential approval by equipment category
- **Preference:** Simplified PO types adaptable during implementation

20. PO Structure and Details [00:57 - 01:00]

- **Order Date:** Tracking required
- **Expected Due Date:** Driven by vendor/item lead times
- **Vendor Contact:** Optional tracking
- **Default Vendor:** Tracked in item master
- **Alternate Vendors:** Alternate vendor pricing also tracked
- **Pricing:** Default and negotiated vendor pricing

21. Automated Requisition Based on Min/Max [01:00 - 01:03]

- **Mechanism:** System calculates shortfall quantities
- **Planning Bench:** Real-time dashboard available
- **Suggestion:** Auto-suggests POs for multiple items per vendor
- **Consolidation:** Can consolidate demand for same vendor across items
- **User Control:** Users can choose to buy only specific items or full suggestion

22. Master Planner and NP Data [01:03 - 01:05]

- **Visibility:** Detailed control over PO lines and filtering
- **List Views:** Can filter by item type, family, branch, category
- **MP Data:** Optional data structure for deeper control
- **Real-time Loading:** Planning bench loads in real time when refreshed

23. Rental Supply/Demand Tracking [01:05 - 01:07]

- **Separate Master:** Rental items handled differently than parts/supplies
- **Expected Return Dates:** Can estimate but caution advised for decisions

- **Open-Ended Rentals:** Mostly open-ended requiring general guesses

24. Iterative Adoption of Planning Features [01:07 - 01:09]

- **Approach:** Assume 95% out-of-box functionality sufficient
- **Testing:** Get hands-on system access early
- **Feedback Loop:** Identify gaps iteratively
- **Scope Management:** Small gaps handled in SOW budget; large gaps require approval

25. Automating PO Sending to Vendors [01:09 - 01:12]

- **Options Considered:**
 1. Vendor partner portals (licensing implications)
 2. Experience Cloud customer portals (possible workaround)
 3. PDF email automation (standard Salesforce platform capability)
- **Portal Strategy:** Could use customer portal with vendor user profiles
- **Licensing:** Partner portals not currently budgeted
- **Current Capability:** 15,000 named users allocated for customer portal

26. PO Document Generation [01:12 - 01:15]

- **Options:**
 1. Visualforce pages for PDF (template-based)
 2. Dedicated document generation tools
- **Branding Consideration:** Marketing/brand requirements may influence choice
- **Flexibility:** Can use out-of-box Visualforce with logo/branding adjustments

- **Customization:** Not required to replicate existing PDF exactly

27. Reporting on POs and Invoices [01:15 - 01:18]

- **Capability:** Report on POs without received invoices
- **Integration Consideration:** Acumatica, Salesforce, and AP process monitoring
- **Integration Approach:** Needed for PO receipt and invoicing status

28. Vendor Invoice Integration and 3-Way Matching [01:18 - 01:26]

- **Invoice Entry:** Manual or automated via AP OCR systems
- **Vendor Invoice Generation:** Can generate vendor invoices in Ascent
- **3-Way Match:** PO + Receipt + Invoice matching supported
- **Invoice Control:** Supports invoice control and duplicate prevention
- **Data Flow:** Backflow of invoice data from Acumatica to Salesforce possible
- **Integration Complexity:** Potential complexity with back-integration
- **Recommended Approach:** Create vendor invoices in Ascent, push to Acumatica

29. GL Mapping and Accounting Alignment [01:26 - 01:29]

- **Item Categorization:** Items grouped for inventory vs. expense accounts
- **Joint Agreement:** Operations and accounting must align on groupings
- **GL Coding:** Categorization drives GL account mapping
- **Strategic Importance:** Item grouping = business agreement between operations and accounting
- **Opportunity:** Significant opportunity to improve GL classification from legacy systems

30. Costing Methodologies [01:29 - 01:33]

- **Options Reviewed:** Standard, Average, Last Purchase Price (LPP)
- **Serialized Assets:** Costing implications for high-value equipment
- **Preference:** Last Purchase Price for parts (drives sales price)
- **Equipment:** Standard costing to prevent deals from skewing prices
- **Item-Level Decision:** Can define costing type per item
- **Per-Category Decision:** Equipment, Parts, and Disposables may have different rules
- **Sales Price Automation:** Requirement to auto-update sales price based on LPP changes

31. Fixed Asset Capitalization [01:33 - 01:36]

- **Tracking:** Through item master
- **Trigger:** Asset put-in-use initiates capitalization
- **Useful Life:** Tracked per item
- **Depreciation:** Starts upon utilization or per master data
- **Capitalization Method:** Either via invoice receipt or accrual accounting if invoice pending
- **Action Item:** Useful life field required in item master

32. PO Line Linkage for Drop-Ship [01:36 - 01:40]

- **Supported:** PO line can link to sales order for drop-ship scenarios
- **Rental Thresholds:** Automation of purchase proposals explained
- **Reservation:** Linkage creates reservation for specific work order

33. Receiving Process Flows [01:40 - 01:44]

- **Default Location:** Based on item master and stock room assignments
- **Inspection:** Required before final receipt (varies by item category)
- **Differentiation:** Equipment has more stringent inspection than medicine
- **New Items:** Apply same inspection process as established items
- **Packing Verification:** Core process = order vs. packing list match + quantity check

34. Receiving Location Overrides [01:44 - 01:51]

- **Default Address:** From branch location via address tracker
- **Override Capability:** Can override during receiving (truck delivery example)
- **Multiple Shipping Addresses:** Can have multiple addresses per PO line
- **Clone PO:** Available for difficult deliveries requiring split shipments
- **Limitation:** Should not change delivery city for audit trail clarity

35. Freight Integration [01:50 - 01:51]

- **Partner:** Zencraft (acquired by Bring)
- **Typical Use:** Fulfillment tracking to customers
- **Vendor Shipments:** Vendors ship on their accounts (preferred)
- **Tracking Integration:** Possible if vendors ship on company accounts
- **Reference Matching:** PO number as reference can match tracking data
- **Limitation:** Not primary use case; custom development may be needed

36. Reporting on Overdue/Undelivered POs [01:51 - 01:53]

- **Due Date Tracking:** Order and expected due dates for reporting

- **Overdue Identification:** Report on POs past due date
- **Invoice Mismatch:** Flag invoices received without PO receipt
- **Closure Prevention:** Mechanisms to avoid closing POs without receipt

37. Inventory Disposal and Consumption [01:53 - 01:57]

- **Disposal Method:** Via bill of materials associations
- **Consumables in Rentals:** Consumption tracked via linked items
- **Threshold Monitoring:** Min/max thresholds monitored in planning bench
- **Disposable Items:** No expectation of return; consumed during rental
- **Minimum Quantities:** Defined per item for automatic replenishment

38. Fixed Asset Register and Depreciation [01:57 - 02:00]

- **Entry Point:** Asset added upon invoice receipt or accrual accounting
- **Accrual Method:** If invoice not received, accrued equipment account used
- **Depreciation Commencement:** Tied to utilization or master data flag

TRADE AGREEMENTS & PRICING

39. Trade Agreement Structure [01:06:00 - 01:09:00]

- **Definition:** Agreements that set pricing for PO, sales, or rental orders
- **Applicability:** Line or order level
- **Trade Object:** Specifies pricing rules
- **Granularity Options:**

- Specific vendor + specific item
- Specific vendor + item group
- Vendor group + specific item
- **Use Case:** Contracted pricing, volume discounts, promotional pricing
- **Purchase Side:** Likely minimal use (one-to-one vendor/item mapping)
- **Rental Side:** Heavy use for establishing rental prices

40. Vendor Pricing Strategy [01:10:00 - 01:14:00]

- **Default Price:** Item master cost is default PO price
- **Override Method:** Trade agreements override item master price
- **Last Purchase Price:** Driving factor for sales price
- **Costing Type Selection:** Per-item decision (standard, average, or LPP)
- **Action:** Finalize item categorization to determine costing rules

OUTSTANDING DECISIONS & ACTION ITEMS

#	Item	Timestamp	Owner	Status
1	Finalize decision on handling legacy sales orders	[00:06]	Unassigned	Open
2	Define operational agreement for returns without sales orders	[00:09]	Unassigned	Open
3	Determine cutover timing from legacy system	[00:12]	Unassigned	Open
4	Enumerate data points for case captures in Salesforce	[00:15]	Unassigned	Open

5	Decide on default hub object for Salesforce intake (Case vs. Sales Order vs. Custom)	[00:23]	Unassigned	Priority
6	Confirm patient data placement for invoicing (header vs. line)	[00:29]	Unassigned	Open
7	Ensure patient data access controls align with Salesforce	[00:39]	Salesforce Team / Partner	Open
8	Cascade attendance and agenda for asset introduction/exit meetings	[00:39]	Unassigned	Open
9	Review and adapt out-of-the-box PO processes	[00:42]	Unassigned	Open
10	Define requisition process specifics and approvals	[00:52]	Unassigned	Open
11	Decide approach to automate PO sending to vendors	[01:09]	Unassigned	Open
12	Confirm reporting mechanisms for outstanding invoices	[01:15]	Unassigned	Open
13	Define handling of 3-way match and vendor invoice integration	[01:18]	Unassigned	Priority
14	Finalize item master categorizations and GL mapping	[01:26]	Operations & Accounting	Priority
15	Set costing methodology and test scenarios	[01:29]	Finance & Operations	Priority
16	Confirm receiving process steps and stock room assignments	[01:40]	Unassigned	Open
17	Review freight integration scope and capabilities	[01:51]	Technical Team	Open
18	Establish procedural controls for minimum inventory levels	[01:53]	Operations	Open
19	Review fixed asset capitalization and depreciation triggers	[01:57]	Finance	Open

KEY DECISIONS DOCUMENTED

Confirmed:

- Service Cloud as hub for all inbound interactions
- All interactions will result in a work order
- Case will remain open until orders finalized
- Rental swaps are continuations (no billing interruption)
- Focus PO process on inventory-impacting assets first
- 3-way match (PO + Receipt + Invoice) capability available
- Useful life tracking in item master for depreciation
- Out-of-box Ascent capabilities expected to meet 95% of needs

Pending Decisions:

- Hub object for intake (Case vs. Sales Order vs. Custom)
- Item master categorization framework
- Costing methodology by item type
- Vendor invoice integration approach (Ascent-centric vs. Acumatica-centric)
- Cutover strategy and data migration scope
- Patient data placement (header vs. line level)

NEXT STEPS

1. **Asset Introduction/Exit Planning** – Organize follow-up session with Robert's team and Liz
2. **Hub Object Decision** – Determine intake hub architecture (required soon)

3. **Item Master Framework** – Joint session with Operations and Accounting on categorization
 4. **Costing Methodology** – Finance, Operations, and IT alignment meeting
 5. **Vendor Invoice Integration** – Technical discussion on 3-way match implementation
 6. **Data Point Enumeration** – Map all legacy system data to Service Cloud case fields
 7. **Cutover Strategy** – Develop detailed data migration and parallel system plan
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ATTENDEES & PARTICIPANTS

- **Primary Facilitator:** Tom (Ascent/Implementation)
 - **Operations Lead:** Srinivas (Host)
 - **Key Contributors:** Brian, Eric, Paula, Robert, Liz, Rich, Sherry, and technical team members
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Document Prepared By: Fred, Fireflies.ai Meeting Assistant

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Meeting Duration: 121 minutes

Total Discussion Points: 40+ major topics

This MOM document captures the strategic planning session for Salesforce Service Cloud and Ascent Order & Inventory implementation. All timestamps reference the meeting recording for detailed context.